DO YOU KNOW...?

Dr.Henk Bekedam is the WHO representative of India. He took up his role on 27 November 2015. He is a Dutch National and a medical Doctor by training.

The WHO guidelines on Nutrition are as follows:

- Baby friendly Hospital initiative.
- Calcium supplementation in pregnant women.
- Consultation on the Dietary management of moderate malnutrition in under 5 children.
- Daily iron and folic acid supplementation in pregnant women.
- Interventions on diet and physical activity.
- Use of multiple micronutrient powders for home fortification of foods consumed by infants and children 6-23 months of age.
- Vitamin A supplementation for infants 1-5 months of age.
- Vitamin A supplementation for infants and children 6-59 months of age.
- Vitamin A supplementation for postpartum women.
- Vitamin A supplementation in pregnant women.
- Weekly Iron- Folic acid Supplementation (WIFS) in women of reproductive age.

12.4.3. United Nations International Children's Fund (UNICEF)

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) was created at the end of World War II in 1946 to relieve the suffering of children in war torn Europe and for the past 70 years UNICEF has strived to improve the lives of children and their families throughout the world. UNICEF's nutritional priorities include:

- Infant and Child feeding.
- Delivering vital micro-nutrients.
- Promoting maternal nutrition/ preventing low birth weight.
- Monitoring infant growth rates.
- Providing nutrition in emergencies.
- Preventing death from starvation and disease.
- Supporting community based programmes.

Education is the key to opportunities and UNICEF believes that quality education is a right for all children, whether in the developing world or amidst conflict and crisis. UNICEF believes that all children have a right to survive, thrive and fulfill their potential for the benefit of a better world.

Summary

- The ICDS was initiated in 1975 with the twin objective of ensuring nutrition of preschool children through supplementary feeding and psychosocial development through early stimulation and education.

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